complexities, such as side effects), you will be acting optimally at the population level, but not necessarily at the individual level.

Figure 7.3. Here we compare simulated Drug A to Drug X to see which lowers blood pressure the most. Drug A has a lower average (expected) value of –15.5 mmHg and a lower standard deviation, but Drug X is bimodal with one mode centered at –22.5 mmHg. Notice that for Drug X virtually no patients had a blood pressure change that fell near the average value.